

JesusOnline Equip

Ministry Resources Hub

Become a Growing Church

A Total Life Discipleship Church

A free resource from JesusOnline.

Read or share online: equip.jesonline.com/channels/church/become-growing-church/a-total-life-discipleship-church

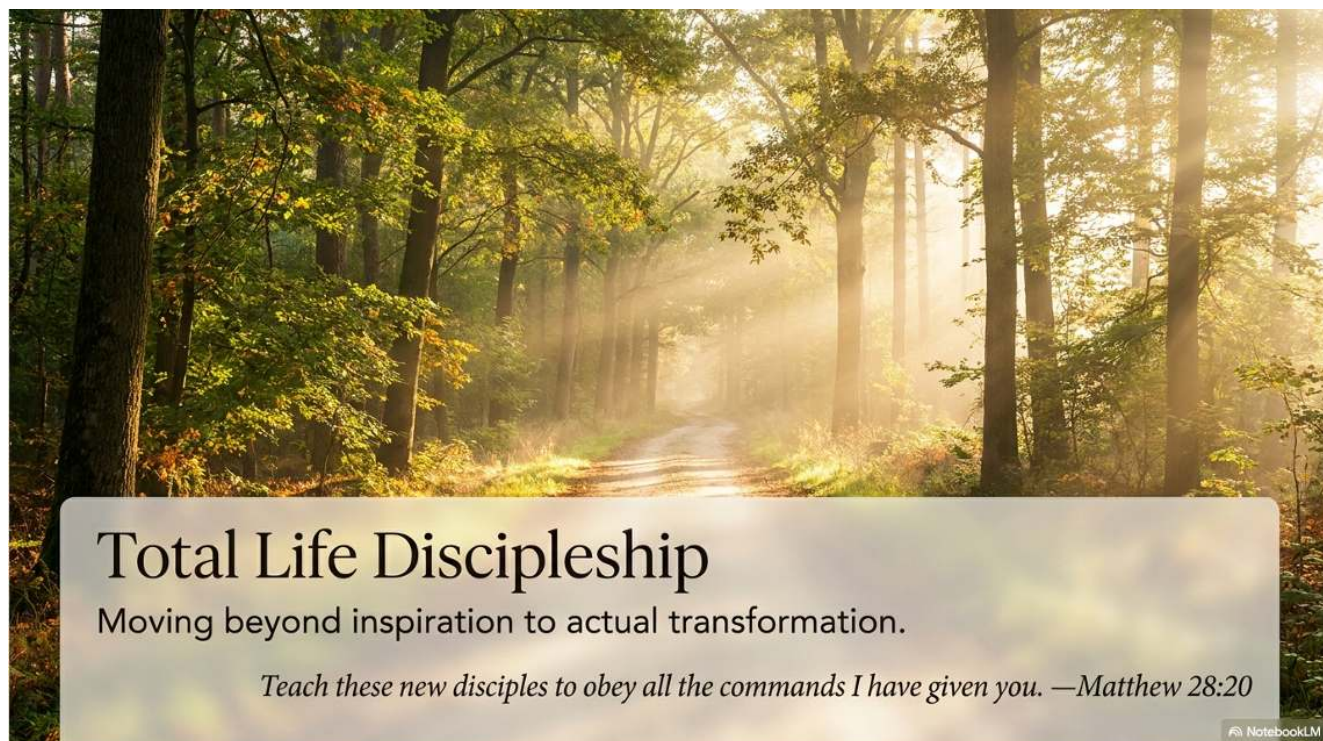
JesusOnline Equip · Ministry Resources Hub · equip.jesonline.com

Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

A Total Life Discipleship Church

Teach these new disciples to obey all the commands I have given you. ...

— Matthew 28:20, NLT



Total Life Discipleship refers to JesusOnline's philosophy and approach to Christian discipleship.

Christian discipleship is a lifelong journey of becoming more like Jesus in every way, so as to expand His Kingdom on earth as it is in heaven. Jesus is our Master Teacher. This journey is faith-driven and action-oriented (cf. Matthew 25:14-30; Luke 19:11-27), and it is measured by obedience (read more in [Anatomy of Obedience](#)). Its goal is far loftier, and its scope far greater, than our individual spiritual growth and change.

Total Life Discipleship begins with God's vision of us, leads to personal transformation into the likeness of Christ, and flows outward into eternal impact for His kingdom. It is a grace-filled journey that invites every believer to align their

entire existence with God's eternal purposes. At its core, this discipleship is relationship-centered, grace-based, Spirit-dependent, love-motivated, and biblically focused — five pillars that keep our walk with the Lord both authentic and fruitful.

God's Vision: Seeing Life from His Perspective

Every journey of discipleship must begin where God begins — with His loving vision of us.

Our heavenly Father sees not our failures or frailties but the finished work of His Son. *"Anyone who belongs to Christ has become a new person. The old life is gone; a new life has begun!"* (2 Corinthians 5:17, NLT).

He knit each of us together with intentional care (Psalm 139:13-14). Our personalities, strengths, and even our weaknesses serve His design. Before we drew our first breath, He set us apart for kingdom purposes (Jeremiah 1:5). When we rest in His unwavering love — *"Abide in My love"* (John 15:9) — circumstances lose their power to define us. We begin to view ourselves, others, and our daily paths through the clarifying light of His truth.

This inspiring vision is foundational to obedience. It renews our minds with God's perspective, replacing worldly lies with biblical truth and grounding every command in His fatherly care.



Personal Transformation: Becoming the Person God Created You to Be

God's vision is meant to be lived out. Transformation begins at the moment of salvation, when our old identity is exchanged for a new one in Christ (Ephesians 4:21-24). Yet this new life must be nurtured to maturity as a lifelong process of renewal by the Holy Spirit.

Experiential knowledge of grace stirs holy desires, and gratitude for Christ's sacrifice shifts obedience from a burdensome duty to a joyful response of love.

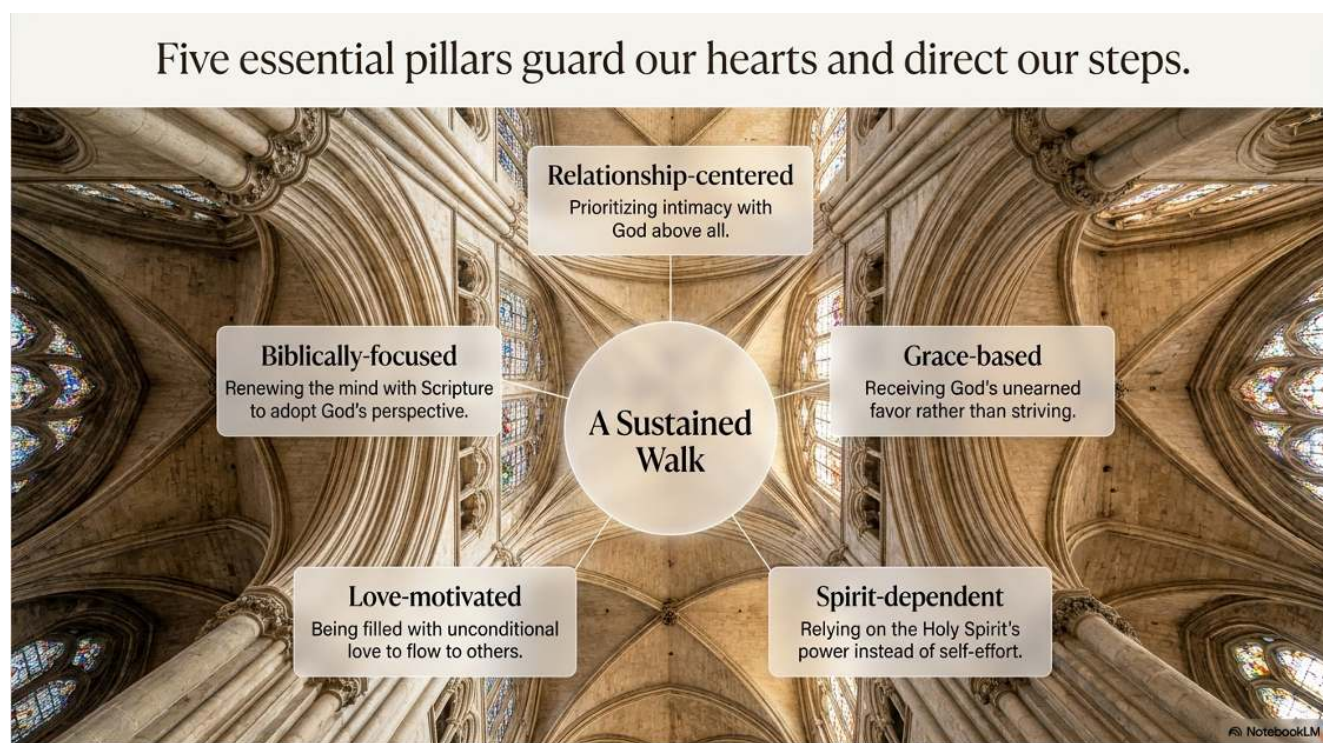
True change touches the core of our character — our values, convictions, and responses. *"Let God transform you into a new person by changing the way you think"* (Romans 12:2, NLT). Trials refine us, building endurance and trust so that we reflect more of Christ's nature (Romans 5:3-4; 8:28). As we comprehend the breadth, length, depth, and height of God's love, we are filled with His fullness (Ephesians 3:17-19). Love received becomes love reflected.

Eternal Impact: Pursuing God's Master Plan

A life transformed by God naturally bears lasting fruit. We were created *"to do the good things He planned for us long ago"* (Ephesians 2:10, NLT). Our days are not accidental; God has placed us in this generation with specific gifts, experiences, and relationships to advance His kingdom.

Eternal impact flows from obedient partnership with the Lord — dependent on the Holy Spirit rather than obstinate self-effort. *"I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength"* (Philippians 4:13). We steward time, talent, and treasure for heaven's sake, investing in what matters to God and storing up treasures that never fade (Matthew 6:21).

The Five Pillars That Sustain the Journey



Total Life Discipleship stands firmly on truths that guard our hearts and direct our steps:

- **Relationship-centered:** Prioritizing intimacy with God above all, then with believers and others.
- **Grace-based:** Receiving God's unearned favor rather than striving to earn it.

- **Spirit-dependent:** Relying on the Holy Spirit's power instead of self-effort.
- **Love-motivated:** Being filled with God's unconditional love and allowing it to flow through us to others.
- **Biblically-focused:** Renewing our mind with Scripture to adopt God's perspective, replacing worldly viewpoints and values.

These pillars keep discipleship balanced, preventing both burnout and complacency. They ensure that exhortation stirs the heart while teaching equips the hands, producing disciples who obey all that Jesus commanded.

A Daily Invitation to Walk with Christ

Total Life Discipleship is not a program to complete but a daily invitation to walk intimately with the One who formed you, redeemed you, and calls you by name. As you behold His vision, yield to His transforming work, and step faithfully into His purposes, your life of eternal significance will one day receive the Lord's approval: *"Well done, good and faithful servant"* (Matthew 25:21, NKJV).



Total Life Discipleship

[Part 1: Core Principles](#)

PDF

VIDEO

APP

[Part 2: Kingdom Perspective](#)

PDF

VIDEO

APP

[Part 3: Building Blocks for Maturity](#)

PDF

VIDEO

APP

Sign up and register your church today to become a FREE JO EQUIPPED Church. →

A daily invitation to walk closely with the One who calls you by name.

Total Life Discipleship is not a program to complete, but a lifelong posture. Enhance engagement and retention long after the service ends with free tools to help you review, remember, and apply.

Core Principles
(PDF • Video • App)

Kingdom
Mentality
(PDF • Video • App)

Building Blocks
for Maturity
(PDF • Video • App)

Have you already registered to become a FREE JesusOnline EQUIPPED Church?

NotebookLM

Thank you for downloading this free resource!

We're grateful you've taken this step in your spiritual journey. Your growth in Christ encourages us, and we pray this has been a blessing—strengthening your faith, deepening your understanding of God's Word, and equipping you to live for His glory.

Share Your Thoughts

Your feedback helps us improve future resources and encourages others:

Leave a Review or Send Us a Note — If you found this helpful, please consider leaving a short review. Your honest words make a big difference! We love hearing how God is using these materials in your life.

Share Your Story → equip.jesonline.com/reviews/share

Discover More Free Resources

Continue growing in your walk with Jesus. Here are additional tools from the JO EQUIP library and JesusOnline Ministries:

- **Explore the Free Books** → equip.jesonline.com/books
- **Download the Free JO App** — Your personal discipleship hub with the NET Bible, daily devotions, interactive studies, prayer tools, more books, and videos. [Download for Android](#) · [Download for iOS](#) · Explore in browser → app.jesonline.com
- **Watch Video Playlists** → equip.jesonline.com/playlists
- **Visit JesusOnline Ministries** — For more about this ministry and global outreach: jesonlineministries.org

Would you like to help others? Share this resource (or the download link) with friends, your small group, or your church. Every copy planted can bear eternal fruit!

Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

Apologetics • Evangelism • Discipleship • Equipping